

Extra project ideas

Unit 1 School portraits

You will need:

At least one digital camera, a printer, large sheets of paper, and cardboard.

For this project, students produce portraits of their classmates (singly or in groups) and/or portraits of other people in the school, e.g., teachers, administrative staff, the principal.

Tell students what the focus of the project is (classmates and/or people in the school). If the latter, brainstorm the people they can photograph and write about. Write the steps of the project on the board for students to copy into their notebooks:

Step 1: Make groups of four.

Step 2: Decide whose portraits to take.

Step 3: Take the pictures. Prepare the posters.

Step 4: Print the pictures. Stick them on the posters.

Step 5: Write a draft of the text on paper. Check the writing of another group.

Step 6: Write a final version of the text on paper. Stick it on the poster. Give the poster a title and decorate it.

Step 7: Display the posters in the school.

Monitor and guide students as they are working, making sure all have access to the camera and can print their images. Help students with their drafts. They can use the text on Student's Book page 17 as a model if appropriate. If they want to write a different text, provide them with a model on the board or on paper. Encourage students to swap their work for peer correction at Step 5.

If possible, display their work around the school for other students, teachers, and parents to see.

Unit 2 My model room

You will need:

One shoe box (or something similar) for each group of students, cardboard, empty bottles, small boxes, etc. for the furniture, samples of wallpaper, material (for carpets, rugs, etc.), paints, glue, scissors, paper.

For this project, students produce a 3-D model of a room in a house. They make the furniture out of cardboard, empty bottles, etc., decorate the walls with paint or samples of wallpaper and use material for rugs and carpets. They write about their room and place the text next to their model. Groups take turns presenting their rooms to the rest of the class.

Tell students what the focus of the project is (making a room in a house). If you have time to make a room before the lesson, show it to them. Write the steps of the project on the board for students to copy into their notebooks:

Step 1: Make groups of four.

Step 2: Decide which room to do and make a list of the furniture.

Step 3: Decide who is going to make which pieces of furniture. Make the furniture and paint it.

Step 4: Decide the color(s) of the room. Paint it. Cut out the rugs and carpet. Put them in the room. Put the furniture in the room.

Step 5: Write a draft of the text on paper. Check the writing of another group.

Step 6: Write a final version of the text on paper. Place the room on a table with the text next to it.

Step 7: Present your room to the class.

Monitor and guide students as they are working, making sure they all keep on task, don't take too long on any one step, and don't try to be too ambitious. Help students with their drafts. They can use parts of the text on Student's Book page 25 as a model as appropriate. If they want to write a different text, provide them with a model on the board or on paper. Encourage students to swap their work for peer correction at Step 5.

Each group should have time to present its room to the rest of the class. Leave the rooms and texts on display in the classroom. If possible, display their work around the school for other students, teachers, and parents to see.

Unit 3 How the heart works

You will need:

An empty jam jar, a large balloon cut off at the neck, two bendy drinking straws, a skewer, scissors, water, tape, a large bowl – all of these items for each group of students.

A completed model pump made according to the instructions below. Note: Make sure the holes you make in the stretched balloon are not too big. The straws need to fit in with no air getting into the jar.

For this project, students work in groups to make a model of a pump. They put water through the pump to find out how the heart pumps blood around the body. They also learn the function of valves in the heart.

Tell students what the focus of the project is (making a model and doing an experiment to show how the heart works). Write the steps of the project on the board for students to copy into their notebooks:

Step 1: Make groups of three or four.

Step 2: Pour water in the jar until it is half full.

Step 3: Put the big part of the balloon over the top of the jar to make a lid. Pull it down as hard as you can to make the top apartment.

Step 4: Make two holes in the balloon lid, about two centimeters apart.

Step 5: Put the straws into the holes.

Step 6: Put the small part of the balloon onto one of the straws. Stick it with tape.

Step 7: Put the jar in a big bowl. Bend the straws down. Press the middle of the balloon on top of the jar. What happens to the water in the jar?

Monitor and guide students as they are working, helping them to make holes in Step 4 and to stick the balloon on the straw in Step 6. You might want to make a model pump at the front of the class, step-by-step, with the students copying you. All the students in each group should try pushing the balloon lid to see what happens for Step 7. The completed pump should look like this:



Elicit/explain in L1 that students have made a pump. Teach the English word. Explain/elicite that the balloon stuck on the straw stopped water going back down the straw – it works like a valve. Explain to students that the heart pumps blood into the body in this way (the straws represent arteries in this model). The heart has four sections, each of which works like the model they have made. If time, take the balloon valve off the straw and pump water again. Show students that without the valve, there is nothing to stop the water from going back down the straw.

Unit 4 Changing money

You will need:

Calculator and a piece of paper for each pair of students, the chart below copied on the board (include four currencies in the left-hand column, e.g., U.S. dollar, Australian dollar, euro / your local currency). Your students will need access to the Internet/photocopies of a newspaper page showing current exchange rates.

Currencies	Exchange rate
U.S. \$ to GB £	
U.S. \$ to euro €	
U.S. \$ to Australian \$	
U.S. \$ to Swiss franc CHF	

Prompts for the role play, written on poster paper, to display for Step 6, e.g.,

Can I help you?

I'd like to change some money from ...s into ...s, please.

How much?

That's ... Here you are. Goodbye.

Thank you. Goodbye.

For this project, students find out about exchange rates and make calculations to convert sums of money in dollars to different currencies. They also role-play working at a bank, changing money.

Tell students what the focus of the project is (finding out about exchange rates and practicing doing sums with different currencies). Pre-teach *exchange rate* and *currency/currencies*. Write the steps of the project on the board for students to copy into their notebooks.

Step 1: Make pairs.

Step 2: Copy the Exchange rate chart onto a piece of paper.

Step 3: Find out the exchange rates for the different currencies.

Step 4: Figure out how much these amounts are in each currency: \$3.00, \$50.00, \$100.00. Use a calculator.

Step 5: Compare your answers with another pair. Then show your teacher.

Step 6: Role-play changing money at a bank. Take turns being (a) the cashier and (b) the customer. Use the ideas on the board.

Step 7: Make groups of four. Perform your role play for the other pair.

Monitor and guide students as they are working through the steps of this project. Check the answers at Step 3 and Step 4. Listen in on the role plays in Step 6 and focus students on the prompts on the board. Make sure they swap roles so each has a chance to be the customer. Choose pairs to perform their role play for the whole class or ask students to write out their dialog.

Unit 5 Keeping our school healthy

You will need:

Large sheets of paper, colors, glue, pictures from magazines.

For this project, students make posters about being and staying healthy to display around the school. They also plan a “School health week” with suggestions for what students in the school should do each day. They monitor the project in each class throughout the week and then report the results, again on a poster.

Tell students what the focus of the project is (giving information about staying healthy in the school, planning a School health week, monitoring the results and reporting them). Write the steps of the project on the board for students to copy into their notebooks. Brainstorm other ideas for the three main areas (as on Student’s Book page 52): *Sleep and rest*, *Exercise*, *Healthy eating*. (Note: On the posters, students should use the imperative, e.g., *Eat ...*).

Step 1: Make six groups.

Step 2: Design a poster about being healthy. Use pictures and colors to make it attractive. Display the posters around the class and read each other’s.

Step 3: As a class, decide what healthy things other students should do each day of the School health week.

Step 4: Make five groups. Choose some healthy things for students to do on your day of the week.

Step 5: Make a poster. Write the day of the week at the top and the healthy things the students should do that day.

Step 6: Display the six Health posters around the school and the five School health week posters in school hallways or the gymnasium. Present your project to the school at an assembly.

Step 7: In the same group as for Step 4, collect the information from different classes for your day. Report the information on your poster and at a school assembly.

Monitor and guide students as they are working through the steps of this project, in particular when they are talking about the project to the other students in the school and planning/writing the healthy things for other students to do on their day of the week (Step 4). Make sure there is variety for each day and from day to day (food/exercise/rest). The collecting of data will need some structure, too, though this does not have to be exact numbers of students.

Unit 6 A nature table

You will need:

A table for display, objects from nature to provide examples (e.g., leaves, pine cones, flowers, tree bark, twigs), paper for labeling, paint.

For this project, students make a collection of objects from nature that are around them. What they collect/display will depend on where your school is and the time of year. However, even if it is winter and your school is in the city, you will be surprised at the number of objects from nature there are. The objects are displayed on a nature table for discussion. Students then choose their favorite objects and write about them in their notebooks.

If students have collected leaves or other objects that they can use to make prints, they can make prints in their notebooks, too.

Note: Make sure that none of the objects students collect for display are poisonous.

Tell students what the focus of the project is (collecting, categorizing, and displaying objects from nature and then writing about them). Tell them they might also be able to do some printing and/or painting. Show students the objects you have brought in for the Nature table. As a class, go out to the playground or local park to collect some objects for the table. If you can’t do this, set a task for students over a weekend to find and bring something for the following week. Write the steps of the project on the board for students to copy into their notebooks:

Step 1: Make groups of four. Show each other your nature objects. Come and place them on the Nature table.

Step 2: Write labels for the objects. Place the labels next to the objects.

Step 3: In pairs, draw a mind map on paper for one of the categories your teacher talks about. Display the paper close to the Nature table.

Step 4: In your notebook, draw a picture of the Nature table. Draw the six objects that are your favorites.

Step 5: Make a print of one of the objects in your notebook. Label the object and write the date.

The setting up of this project is important. Begin with a small range of natural objects and encourage students to add to the table over time. The best way is to go out as a class to a park to collect natural objects. For Step 2, hand out the objects to students. They write a label and then place the object and the label back on the Nature table. Before Step 3, talk about the different categories (e.g., flowers, from trees, brown) that you have. The categories will depend on what the students have collected. There should be enough categories for each pair to draw a different mind map.

For Step 5, prints can be made of many different objects, e.g., bark, leaves, flowers, twigs, pine cones.

Unit 7 Animals and their habitats

You will need:

Access to the Internet, reference books, large sheets of paper, colors, glue, magazines or brochures.

For this project, students find out about special/typical/unusual animals in their country. They research their habitats and what they eat and find out what they can about them. They create a poster for their animals that they present to the class and/or to other classes in the school.

Tell students what the focus of the project is (finding out about unusual/special/typical animals from their country). Some students might want to focus on endangered animals. If they can't find animals to focus on that are from their country, they can focus on the region/continent. The object is for them to learn about the animals and to find out some things they didn't know before. Brainstorm regional/unusual animals with the class to provide them with ideas, and write them on the board. Write the steps of the project on the board for students to copy into their notebooks:

- Step 1: Make pairs.*
- Step 2: Choose four animals from the ones on the board.
Check with your teacher if any of your animals are not on the board.*
- Step 3: Find out about your animals: habitat, food, habits.
Make notes about your animals.*
- Step 4: Design the poster. Find/draw a picture of your animals and write their names. Draw other pictures that give information, e.g., about food. Give your poster a title.*
- Step 5: Write a draft of the texts about the animals on paper, using your notes. Check the writing of another group.*
- Step 6: Write a final version of the texts on paper. Stick them onto the poster.*
- Step 7: Display the poster and present your information about your animals to the class.*

Provide students with relevant reference books / Internet sites for Step 3. Remind them to find out new information about their animals: they should be animals that are special for some reason. Monitor and guide students as they are working, making sure they gather balanced information. The poster titles (Step 4) will depend on the animals chosen, e.g., *Endangered animals*, *Unique mammals*, *Migratory animals*. Help students with their drafts. Encourage students to swap their work for peer correction at Step 5.

Each group should have time to present the information about their animals to the rest of the class. Leave the posters on display in the classroom. If possible, display their work around the school for other students, teachers, and parents to see.

Unit 8 Making an orchestra

You will need:

Empty glass bottles of different sizes, water, metal spoons (xylophone)
Paper plates, hole punch, string, bells / metal buttons (tambourine)
Empty boxes with lids, string, sticks / wooden spoons (drums)
Metal jar lids (cymbals)
Colored pencils, scissors, sequins, glue for decoration.

For this project, students make different musical instruments and then play together in an orchestra. When all the instruments are finished, group the students by instrument for the concert. Choose a song they know from *Kid's Box AE*, play it on the CD, and conduct the students to join in with the rhythm. Write the instructions for each instrument on a different piece of paper to hand out to the students. Everyone makes their own instrument. You can also reuse the instruments from the classroom project.

Instructions:

Xylophone: Put different amounts of water in the bottles, put the lids on and then strike them (gently) with the metal spoons.
Tambourine: Stick two paper plates together, facing each other. Make holes around the edge (not too close) and tie bells / metal buttons on.
Drums: Make a hole in the lid and in the bottom of the box. Thread string through and make a long loop so they can be worn. Hit with the sticks.
Cymbals: Strike the metal jar lids together.

Tell students what the focus of the project is (making musical instruments for a concert). Write the steps of the project on the board for students to copy into their notebooks:

- Step 1: Choose which instrument to make.*
- Step 2: Read the instructions and make the instrument.*
- Step 3: Decorate the instrument.*
- Step 4: Make groups of four. Tell your friends about your instrument, its name, and how you made it.*
- Step 5: As a class, choose some songs from Kid's Box AE to play.
Stand where your teacher tells you and play each one in the orchestra.*

Monitor and guide students as they are working, making sure they have all the relevant materials and that they are following the instructions to make their instrument. Encourage them to try it out as they make it and to make adjustments if the sound isn't right. Step 4 is important as it allows them to talk about their instrument to their friends. They might want to play it, too, so it could be noisy! If you prefer, you can choose the songs they are going to play. Arrange the students in instrument groups and use a stick as a baton for conducting. At this stage, the rhythm is more important than the melody. If time, students can write about what they did in their notebooks, e.g., *Today we made musical instruments. I made a ...*